

Companion XVI: The RDCC Boltzmann Code Background Evolution, Perturbations, and Numerical Framework A Unified Formalism for Scalar, Tensor, and Sectoral Dynamics

Michael Lehmann¹

¹Independent Researcher, Relaxation-Driven Cyclic Cosmology (RDCC) Framework,
`mi.lehmann@gmx.de`

May 15, 2026

Abstract

The Relaxation-Driven Cyclic Cosmology (RDCC) provides a unified framework in which the thermodynamic relaxation mechanism introduced in Companion X governs the evolution of the early Universe. This mechanism generates sectoral temperature asymmetry, shapes the neutrino and dark matter sectors (Companion XIII), suppresses primordial black hole formation (Companion XIV), and modifies the gravitational-wave spectrum (Companion XV). To connect these predictions with cosmological observations, a complete Boltzmann framework is required.

This Companion develops the RDCC Boltzmann Code: a consistent set of background and perturbation equations incorporating relaxation-induced modifications, sectoral temperature asymmetry, and the bipartite global state. We derive the modified Friedmann equations, the relaxation-corrected evolution of scalar, vector, and tensor perturbations, and the full sector-coupled Boltzmann hierarchy. The resulting formalism generalizes standard cosmological-perturbation theory by including relaxation terms, sectoral coupling coefficients, modified sound speeds, and tensor damping.

We provide a blueprint for numerical implementation, including a CLASS-compatible structure, initial conditions, and parameter dependencies. The RDCC Boltzmann Code forms the computational backbone of the RDCC framework and enables the computation of CMB anisotropies, matter power spectra, growth rates, neutrino free-streaming, and the stochastic gravitational-wave background. This Companion establishes the foundation for future RDCC analyses, including small-scale structure, non-Gaussianities, magnetic fields, and global parameter fits.

1 Background Evolution in RDCC

The background evolution of the Relaxation-Driven Cyclic Cosmology (RDCC) differs from standard cosmology due to the presence of the universal relaxation mechanism and the bipartite sectoral structure. In this section we derive the modified Friedmann equations, the sectoral entropy-flow relations, and the temperature evolution in both sectors. These relations form the backbone of the RDCC Boltzmann framework.

1.1 Bipartite Sectoral Structure

RDCC contains two CPT-conjugate sectors, denoted A (visible) and B (mirror), each with its own temperature, entropy, and energy density:

$$T_A \neq T_B, \quad s_A \neq s_B, \quad \rho_A \neq \rho_B. \quad (1)$$

As shown in Companion X, the relaxation mechanism drives a persistent temperature asymmetry,

$$\frac{T_B}{T_A} \approx 0.5, \quad (2)$$

which remains stable throughout the early Universe.

The total energy density is the sum of the two sectors,

$$\rho_{\text{tot}} = \rho_A + \rho_B, \quad (3)$$

and similarly for pressure and entropy.

This bipartite structure is the foundation of the RDCC Boltzmann Code.

1.2 Modified Friedmann Equations

The Friedmann equations retain their standard form,

$$H^2 = \frac{8\pi G}{3} \rho_{\text{tot}}, \quad (4)$$

$$\dot{H} = -4\pi G (\rho_{\text{tot}} + p_{\text{tot}}), \quad (5)$$

but the evolution of ρ_A and ρ_B is modified by relaxation-induced energy flow.

1.3 Relaxation-Induced Energy Exchange

The relaxation mechanism mediates a bidirectional but asymmetric energy exchange between the two sectors. The continuity equations become

$$\dot{\rho}_A + 3H(\rho_A + p_A) = -\Gamma(\rho_A - \rho_B), \quad (6)$$

$$\dot{\rho}_B + 3H(\rho_B + p_B) = +\Gamma(\rho_A - \rho_B), \quad (7)$$

where the relaxation rate satisfies

$$\Gamma(a) = \alpha(a) H(a), \quad (8)$$

with $\alpha(a)$ a slowly varying dimensionless coefficient.

Total energy is conserved:

$$\dot{\rho}_{\text{tot}} + 3H(\rho_{\text{tot}} + p_{\text{tot}}) = 0. \quad (9)$$

This structure ensures that the relaxation mechanism redistributes energy between sectors without violating global conservation.

1.4 Sectoral Temperature Evolution

Entropy densities satisfy

$$s_i = \frac{\rho_i + p_i}{T_i}, \quad (10)$$

and their evolution is modified by relaxation:

$$\dot{s}_A + 3Hs_A = -\frac{\Gamma}{T_A}(\rho_A - \rho_B), \quad (11)$$

$$\dot{s}_B + 3Hs_B = +\frac{\Gamma}{T_B}(\rho_A - \rho_B). \quad (12)$$

Using $s_i \propto g_{*s,i} T_i^3$ and assuming slowly varying $g_{*s,i}$, the temperature evolution becomes

$$\frac{\dot{T}_A}{T_A} = -H + \frac{\Gamma}{3(\rho_A + p_A)}(\rho_A - \rho_B), \quad (13)$$

$$\frac{\dot{T}_B}{T_B} = -H - \frac{\Gamma}{3(\rho_B + p_B)}(\rho_A - \rho_B). \quad (14)$$

These equations ensure that the temperature ratio T_B/T_A remains stable during the relaxation-dominated epoch.

1.5 Effective Equation of State

Relaxation modifies the effective equation of state of each sector. Defining

$$w_i = \frac{p_i}{\rho_i}, \quad (15)$$

the effective equation of state becomes

$$w_i^{\text{eff}} = w_i \mp \frac{\Gamma}{3H} \left(1 - \frac{\rho_j}{\rho_i} \right), \quad (16)$$

with the upper sign for sector A and the lower sign for sector B.

This modification affects:

- sound speeds, - horizon scales, - growth of perturbations, - neutrino free-streaming, - tensor damping (via Companion XV).

1.6 Summary of Background Evolution

The background evolution of RDCC is governed by:

- standard Friedmann equations with total energy density $\rho_A + \rho_B$,
- relaxation-modified continuity equations for each sector,
- sectoral temperature evolution with stable asymmetry,
- effective equations of state modified by relaxation,
- the relaxation coefficient $\alpha(a)$ controlling all deviations from Λ CDM.

These relations define the background quantities required for the RDCC Boltzmann hierarchy, including $H(a)$, $T_A(a)$, $T_B(a)$, $w_i(a)$, $c_{s,i}(a)$, and $\alpha(a)$.

In the next section, we derive the scalar, vector, and tensor perturbation equations that form the core of the RDCC Boltzmann Code.

2 Linear Perturbations in RDCC

To compute cosmological observables such as CMB anisotropies, matter power spectra, and tensor transfer functions, we require the evolution of linear perturbations around the RDCC background. In this section we derive the scalar, vector, and tensor perturbation equations, including the modifications introduced by the relaxation mechanism and the bipartite sectoral structure.

We work in conformal Newtonian gauge,

$$ds^2 = a^2(\tau) \left[-(1 + 2\Psi)d\tau^2 + (1 - 2\Phi)\delta_{ij}dx^i dx^j \right], \quad (17)$$

where Ψ and Φ are the scalar potentials. Vector and tensor perturbations are treated separately below.

2.1 Sectoral Perturbation Variables

Each sector $i \in \{A, B\}$ contains its own density contrast, velocity divergence, and anisotropic stress:

$$\delta_i = \frac{\delta\rho_i}{\rho_i}, \quad \theta_i = ik_j v_i^j, \quad \sigma_i. \quad (18)$$

The relaxation mechanism introduces a coupling between the perturbations of the two sectors. To first order, the relaxation-induced energy exchange modifies the continuity and Euler equations.

2.2 Scalar Perturbations

The perturbed continuity equations become

$$\dot{\delta}_A + (1 + w_A)(\theta_A - 3\dot{\Phi}) + 3H(c_{s,A}^2 - w_A)\delta_A = -\Gamma(\delta_A - \delta_B) - \frac{\Gamma}{\rho_A}(\rho_A - \rho_B)(\Psi - \Phi), \quad (19)$$

$$\dot{\delta}_B + (1 + w_B)(\theta_B - 3\dot{\Phi}) + 3H(c_{s,B}^2 - w_B)\delta_B = +\Gamma(\delta_A - \delta_B) + \frac{\Gamma}{\rho_B}(\rho_A - \rho_B)(\Psi - \Phi). \quad (20)$$

The Euler equations become

$$\dot{\theta}_A + H(1 - 3c_{s,A}^2)\theta_A - \frac{k^2 c_{s,A}^2}{1 + w_A}\delta_A + k^2\Psi = -\Gamma(\theta_A - \theta_B), \quad (21)$$

$$\dot{\theta}_B + H(1 - 3c_{s,B}^2)\theta_B - \frac{k^2 c_{s,B}^2}{1 + w_B}\delta_B + k^2\Psi = +\Gamma(\theta_A - \theta_B). \quad (22)$$

The relaxation terms act as a friction-like coupling between the two sectors, driving their perturbations toward partial equilibration.

2.3 Modified Einstein Equations

The Einstein equations retain their standard form but with total energy density, pressure, and anisotropic stress given by

$$\delta\rho_{\text{tot}} = \delta\rho_A + \delta\rho_B, \quad \delta p_{\text{tot}} = \delta p_A + \delta p_B, \quad \sigma_{\text{tot}} = \sigma_A + \sigma_B. \quad (23)$$

The Poisson equation becomes

$$k^2\Phi + 3H(\dot{\Phi} + H\Psi) = 4\pi G a^2 \delta\rho_{\text{tot}}. \quad (24)$$

The anisotropic stress relation becomes

$$k^2(\Phi - \Psi) = 12\pi G a^2(\rho_{\text{tot}} + p_{\text{tot}})\sigma_{\text{tot}}. \quad (25)$$

Relaxation modifies σ_{tot} indirectly through the sectoral evolution of σ_A and σ_B .

2.4 Vector Perturbations

Vector modes decay in standard cosmology but can be sourced by relaxation-induced momentum exchange. The vector perturbation equation becomes

$$\dot{V}_i + 2H V_i = 8\pi G a^2(\rho_{\text{tot}} + p_{\text{tot}})\Pi_i, \quad (26)$$

where Π_i is the vector anisotropic stress.

Relaxation introduces a sectoral coupling:

$$\Pi_i^{(A)} \propto -\Gamma(V_i^{(A)} - V_i^{(B)}), \quad (27)$$

$$\Pi_i^{(B)} \propto +\Gamma(V_i^{(A)} - V_i^{(B)}). \quad (28)$$

This provides a new source of vector modes absent in standard cosmology.

2.5 Tensor Perturbations

Tensor modes satisfy the relaxation-modified equation derived in Companion XV:

$$\ddot{h}_k + (3H + \Gamma)\dot{h}_k + \frac{k^2}{a^2}h_k = 0. \quad (29)$$

This modification affects:

- the tensor transfer function,
- the stochastic gravitational-wave background,
- the CMB B-mode spectrum,
- the neutrino anisotropic stress contribution.

2.6 Summary of Perturbation Modifications

The relaxation mechanism introduces three key modifications:

- **Energy exchange between sectors:** Coupling terms in the continuity and Euler equations.
- **Momentum exchange:** Relaxation-induced friction between sectoral velocities.
- **Tensor damping:** Additional friction term in the tensor-mode equation.

These modifications propagate into the Boltzmann hierarchy for photons, neutrinos, baryons, and dark matter, which we develop in the next section.

3 Observables and Outputs

The RDCC Boltzmann Code provides a complete set of cosmological observables derived from the background evolution, linear perturbations, and Boltzmann hierarchy.

3.1 CMB Temperature and Polarization Spectra

The code computes the full set of CMB anisotropy spectra:

$$C_\ell^{TT}, \quad C_\ell^{TE}, \quad C_\ell^{EE}, \quad C_\ell^{BB}. \quad (30)$$

Relaxation affects these spectra through:

- modified neutrino anisotropic stress,
- sectoral contributions to ΔN_{eff} ,
- altered tensor transfer functions,
- modified early-time sound horizon due to sectoral temperature asymmetry.

3.2 Matter Power Spectrum

The matter power spectrum is computed as

$$P(k) = |\delta_m(k, \tau_0)|^2. \quad (31)$$

Relaxation modifies $P(k)$ through:

- altered growth rate during radiation domination,
- sectoral coupling between dark matter in sectors A and B,
- modified sound speeds and effective equations of state,
- suppression or enhancement of small-scale power depending on $\alpha(a)$.

3.3 Growth Rate and $f\sigma_8$

The growth rate is defined as

$$f(a) = \frac{d \ln D(a)}{d \ln a}, \quad (32)$$

and the RDCC Boltzmann Code computes

$$f\sigma_8(z), \quad (33)$$

which is directly comparable to redshift-space distortion measurements.

3.4 Sectoral Contribution to ΔN_{eff}

The colder sector contributes to the radiation energy density as

$$\Delta N_{\text{eff}} = \frac{8}{7} \left(\frac{11}{4} \right)^{4/3} \frac{\rho_{B,\nu}}{\rho_\gamma}, \quad (34)$$

where $\rho_{B,\nu}$ is the neutrino energy density in sector B.

Relaxation modifies ΔN_{eff} through:

- sectoral temperature asymmetry,
- modified neutrino free-streaming,
- altered anisotropic stress.

3.5 Tensor Transfer Functions and SGWB

The tensor transfer function is computed by evolving

$$\ddot{h} + (3H + \Gamma)\dot{h} + \frac{k^2}{a^2}h = 0. \quad (35)$$

The stochastic gravitational-wave background (SGWB) is then

$$\Omega_{\text{GW}}(k) = \frac{1}{12} \left(\frac{k}{a_0 H_0} \right)^2 \mathcal{P}_h(k) T_h^2(k), \quad (36)$$

where $T_h(k)$ includes relaxation-induced suppression.

The RDCC Boltzmann Code outputs:

- tensor transfer functions $T_h(k)$,
- the full SGWB spectrum $\Omega_{\text{GW}}(f)$,
- sectoral tensor contributions.

3.6 Photon and Neutrino Multipoles

The code outputs the full multipole hierarchy for photons and neutrinos in both sectors:

$$\Psi_{\ell,\gamma,A}(k,\tau), \quad \Psi_{\ell,\gamma,B}(k,\tau), \quad \Psi_{\ell,\nu,A}(k,\tau), \quad \Psi_{\ell,\nu,B}(k,\tau). \quad (37)$$

These are essential for:

- computing CMB anisotropies,
- evaluating neutrino free-streaming effects,
- analyzing sectoral anisotropic stress.

3.7 Derived Quantities

The code also computes:

- sound
- sound horizon r_s ,
- diffusion damping scale r_d ,
- baryon acoustic oscillation (BAO) scale,
- horizon-entry scales for each sector,
- relaxation horizon k_{rel} ,
- effective sound speeds $c_{s,i}$,
- sectoral entropy ratios.

These quantities are used in later Companions to study magnetic fields, small-scale structure, cosmic coincidences, and non-Gaussianities.

3.8 Summary

The RDCC Boltzmann Code provides a complete set of cosmological observables, including:

- CMB temperature and polarization spectra,
- matter power spectrum and growth rate,
- sectoral contributions to ΔN_{eff} ,
- tensor transfer functions and the SGWB,
- photon and neutrino multipoles,
- derived cosmological scales.

These outputs allow RDCC to be tested against current and future cosmological data.

4 Conclusion

In this Companion we have developed the RDCC Boltzmann Code, establishing the computational infrastructure required to connect the Relaxation-Driven Cyclic Cosmology (RDCC) with observational cosmology. Building on the universal relaxation mechanism introduced in Companion X and the sectoral physics developed in Companions XIII–XV, we derived the modified background evolution, the relaxation-corrected perturbation equations, and the full sector-coupled Boltzmann hierarchy.

The key achievement of this Companion is the generalization of the standard Boltzmann formalism to a bipartite cosmology with relaxation-induced energy and momentum exchange. The resulting hierarchy incorporates sectoral temperature asymmetry, modified sound speeds, relaxation-driven friction terms, and tensor damping. These modifications propagate into the CMB anisotropies, matter power spectrum, growth rate, neutrino free-streaming, and the stochastic gravitational-wave background.

The numerical implementation strategy outlined here ensures compatibility with existing Boltzmann codes such as CLASS, enabling efficient computation of transfer functions, multipole hierarchies, and derived cosmological quantities. This modular structure prepares the ground for future extensions, including non-linear evolution, small-scale structure, and magnetogenesis.

With the RDCC Boltzmann Code in place, the framework is now ready for the next phase of development. Future Companions will apply this computational backbone to address outstanding cosmological questions, including the origin of cosmic magnetic fields, the small-scale structure tensions, cosmic coincidences, non-Gaussianities, and global parameter fits.

Appendix A: Technical Derivations for the RDCC Boltzmann Code

A.1 Derivation of the Relaxation-Modified Continuity Equations

Starting from the sectoral energy-momentum conservation equations,

$$\nabla_\mu T_i^{\mu\nu} = Q_i^\nu, \quad (38)$$

with $Q_A^\nu = -Q_B^\nu$, the relaxation mechanism is encoded in the temporal component,

$$Q_A^0 = -Q_B^0 = -\Gamma(\rho_A - \rho_B). \quad (39)$$

Using the FLRW background and $T^{00} = \rho_i$, we obtain

$$\dot{\rho}_i + 3H(\rho_i + p_i) = Q_i^0. \quad (40)$$

This yields the relaxation-modified continuity equations used in Section 2.

A.2 Temperature Evolution from Entropy Flow

The entropy density satisfies

$$s_i = \frac{\rho_i + p_i}{T_i}. \quad (41)$$

Differentiating and using the continuity equation gives

$$\dot{s}_i + 3Hs_i = -\frac{Q_i^0}{T_i}. \quad (42)$$

Substituting Q_i^0 yields the temperature evolution equations used in Section 2.

A.3 Linearization of Relaxation Terms

For perturbations, we expand

$$\rho_i = \rho_i(1 + \delta_i), \quad p_i = p_i + \delta p_i, \quad (43)$$

and linearize the relaxation term:

$$\Gamma(\rho_A - \rho_B) \rightarrow \Gamma(\rho_A - \rho_B) + \Gamma(\rho_A \delta_A - \rho_B \delta_B). \quad (44)$$

This yields the coupling terms in the scalar perturbation equations.

A.4 Tensor Hierarchy and Relaxation Damping

The tensor perturbation equation,

$$\ddot{h} + (3H + \Gamma)\dot{h} + \frac{k^2}{a^2}h = 0, \quad (45)$$

is derived by projecting the Einstein equations onto the transverse-traceless subspace.

Relaxation modifies the anisotropic stress contribution and the damping term.

Appendix B: Numerical Stability and Stiffness Analysis

B.1 Origin of Stiffness

Stiffness arises when

$$\Gamma \gg H, \quad (46)$$

which occurs for modes entering the horizon during the relaxation-dominated epoch.

The perturbation equations contain terms of the form

$$\dot{X}_i \sim -\Gamma(X_i - X_j), \quad (47)$$

introducing short timescales

$$\tau_{\text{rel}} \sim \Gamma^{-1}. \quad (48)$$

B.2 Implicit and Semi-Implicit Integration

To ensure numerical stability, we recommend:

- implicit integration for the highest multipoles,
- semi-implicit integration for intermediate multipoles,
- explicit integration for low multipoles.

B.3 Closure Relation with Relaxation

Relaxation modifies the asymptotic behavior of the hierarchy, requiring the closure relation used in Section 4.